

one-skillet unstuffed tomatoes

BY: CAROLINE CHAMBERS

Serves: 4

Cook time: 1 hour

Tools:

- [Chef's knife](#)
- [Cutting board](#)
- 10 or 12 inch OVENPROOF skillet: Any skillet works! I used [cast iron](#), but [nonstick](#) is also great if you have an ovenproof nonstick! Stainless steel is great here, too.
- A mismatched pot lid, baking sheet, or aluminum foil for covering the skillet!

Ingredients:

- 2 tablespoons extra-virgin olive oil
- 1 small yellow onion or large shallot, [finely chopped](#)
- 3 garlic cloves, minced
- 1 pound ground turkey (or any ground meat)
- Kosher salt and freshly ground pepper
- 1 cup white rice (preferably short-grain such as arborio, calrose, or sushi rice — no need to rinse)
- 1 1/2 pounds tomatoes, [diced](#) (or halved, if using cherry tomatoes)
- 1/4 cup finely chopped basil or parsley
- 1 1/2 cups low-sodium chicken stock
- 1 cup panko breadcrumbs (but any kind of breadcrumbs works!)
- 2 tablespoons pesto (any kind! I love the one from Costco!)

Preheat oven to 375°F.

Warm **2 tablespoons olive oil** in a 10-inch ovenproof skillet over medium heat. Cook **1 finely chopped onion** and **3 minced garlic cloves** for 3 to 4 minutes, until the onion has softened. Add **1 pound ground turkey, 1 teaspoon salt, and several grinds of pepper (about 1/4 teaspoon)** and crank the heat up to medium-high. Cook, using a spatula to break the meat up into tiny crumbles, until no longer pink.

Stir in **1 cup short-grain white rice, 1 1/2 pounds diced tomatoes, 1/4 cup finely chopped basil or parsley, and a big pinch of salt (about 1/4 teaspoon)** until combined. Stir in **1 1/2 cups chicken stock**, bring it to a simmer over high heat, then turn off the heat.

Cover the skillet (you can use any mismatched pot lid, or a baking sheet, or aluminum foil!) and bake for 30 minutes.

While the rice is baking, in a small bowl stir together **1 cup panko breadcrumbs and 2 tablespoons pesto** to coat the breadcrumbs.

Remove the lid and test the rice. Is it tender? Proceed with the recipe! Is it still crunchy? Cover and cook for another 5 to 10, until tender.

Remove the lid and spread the pesto breadcrumbs over the rice. Return to the oven for 10 minutes, or until golden-brown.

Let it cool down for 5 minutes, then serve!